

Food for life

You need to eat food so that your body can get the nutrients it needs to grow, and to repair and maintain itself. Some nutrients are needed in large amounts. These include carbohydrates, which supply energy, and proteins, which are used to build and repair your body's cells. Vitamins and minerals are needed in smaller quantities.

WOW!

Water is an important part of your diet. Some fruit contains a lot of liquid—apples are 84 percent water.

A HEALTHY DIET

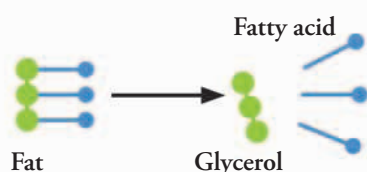
The nutrients you need to stay healthy can be found in food. Different types of food provide different nutrients. This platter shows how much you should eat of each type, compared to the others. For example, you should eat a lot of fresh fruits and vegetables, but not very much meat or fat.

Carrots contain vitamin A. You need this vitamin to keep the eyes healthy.

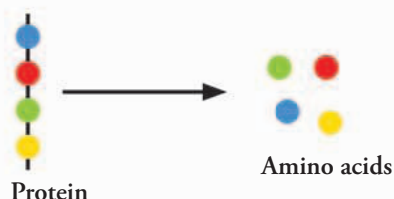
Peppers supply minerals and vitamins and are a good source of fiber. This helps speed up digestion.

BREAKING DOWN FOOD

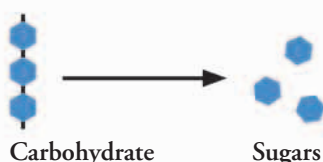
The nutrients that we need are often "locked" inside food and can't be used by your body right away. Your digestive system breaks down complicated foods into simple sugars, fatty acids, and amino acids—the basic building blocks of protein—that the body can absorb and use.



◀ **FATS** These are broken down into simpler glycerol and fatty acid molecules.



◀ **PROTEINS** These are broken down into separate amino acids.



◀ **CARBOHYDRATES** Complex carbohydrates, such as starch, are converted into simple sugars, such as glucose.



Whole grains are a good source of some B vitamins. These help keep your cells healthy.